design decisions, including cache strategies, data processing workflows, REST API data contracts, and template loading mechanisms. These interactions demonstrate a candidate’s ability to bridge the gap between frontend and backend systems.

In addition to fostering cross-team communication, system design interviews emphasize topics such as scalability, performance optimization, and architectural patterns tailored to frontend development. Candidates may be asked to design scalable component hierarchies, optimize rendering performance for high-traffic applications, or propose solutions for managing large datasets efficiently in the browser. Mastering these concepts prepares candidates to excel in system design interviews, which are especially critical for senior-level positions where strategic thinking and cross-domain expertise are essential.

However, technical skills alone are not sufficient in today’s collaborative work environments. Preparation for behavioral interviews is equally important, helping candidates effectively communicate their experiences, showcase their problem-solving approaches, and demonstrate teamwork abilities. This holistic approach ensures candidates are well-rounded and ready for all aspects of the modern frontend interview process. Ultimately, adaptability is key—candidates should be prepared to handle unexpected situations while confidently demonstrating their technical expertise and communication skills during interviews.

1.3 The funneling approach to web development fundamentals

The funneling approach is an interview technique designed to assess the depth of understanding. The process moves from broad, open-ended questions to increasingly specific and technical probes, revealing how well a developer can reason about core concepts and apply them in real-world scenarios.

- *Initial question (broad)*—During the initial, broad question of a frontend interview, the interviewer typically begins with an open-ended prompt such as, "What is the Virtual DOM, and how does React use it?" This